F FOKUS

LEARN ANYTHING, ON PURPOSE

Type any topic.
Get a learning path made for you.

FOKUS turns a topic you want to learn into an eight-module path, then walks you through it: read the guide, watch a real video, pass a short check, move on.

THE PROBLEM

Most people who decide to teach themselves something never finish it.

Self-paced learning asks a beginner to do two jobs at once: work out what to learn, and keep themselves honest while learning it. Most fail at the first, so the second never matters.

85–90%

of self-initiating learners fail to complete their online learning goals or courses (Mukherjee & Kandiah, 2023)

No map

A search bar gives you 40 tabs, not an order. Beginners cannot tell which resource is step one and which is year three.

No feedback

Watching a video feels like progress but proves nothing. Without a check, nothing tells you whether it landed.

HOW SELF-STUDY USUALLY GOES

Search a topic, open twelve tabs, watch whatever is longest, stop after a week.

vs

WITH A PATH

Open module one, do the three steps, check it landed, move to module two.

WHO WE START WITH

Students who already want to learn something specific.

Not the whole learning market. The person who has already decided: I want to learn watercolor, Haskell, chess openings, lab safety. They need a plan, not motivation.

What they look like

- University or college student, 18–24
- Already self-studying outside coursework
- Has a topic in mind, no structure for it
- Studies in short sessions, on a phone as often as a laptop

Why this group first

They are reachable (classmates, campus, student communities), they give feedback in minutes rather than quarters, and their failure mode is exactly what FOKUS fixes.

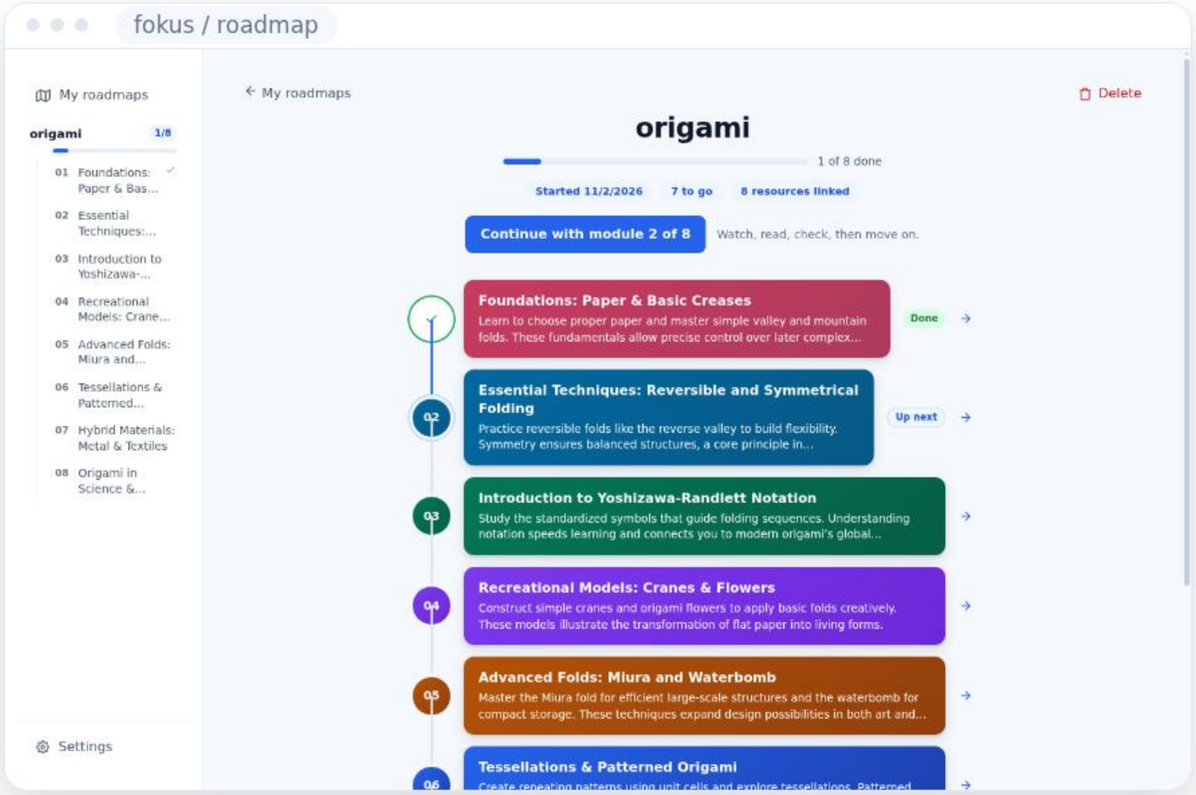
Every later user — a classroom, a training team, a whole faculty — needs the same core thing working first: a topic in, a usable path out.

One clear job: turn my topic into an order I can follow

THE SOLUTION

A map, then a walk through it.

Every roadmap is eight modules in order. Each module is three steps: watch, read, check.
The path is the interface.



Numbered, not endless

Eight modules, in an order. You always know what step you are on and what comes next.

Checked, not assumed

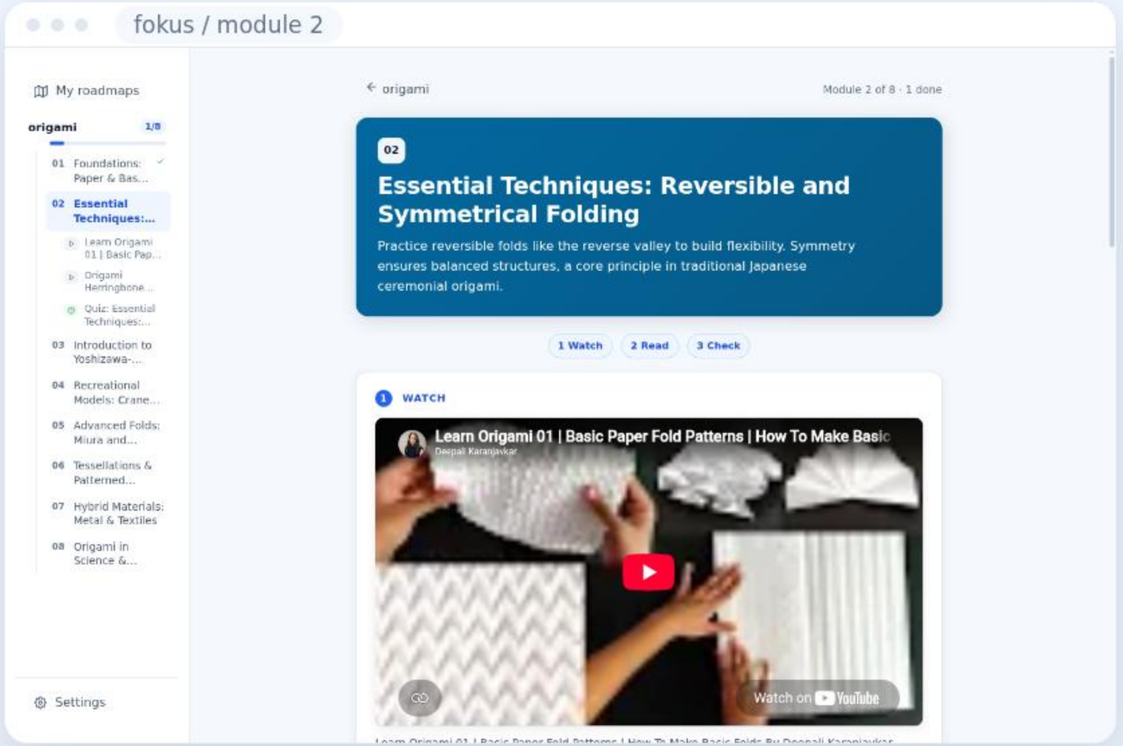
Each module ends with three questions. Two right and the next module unlocks.

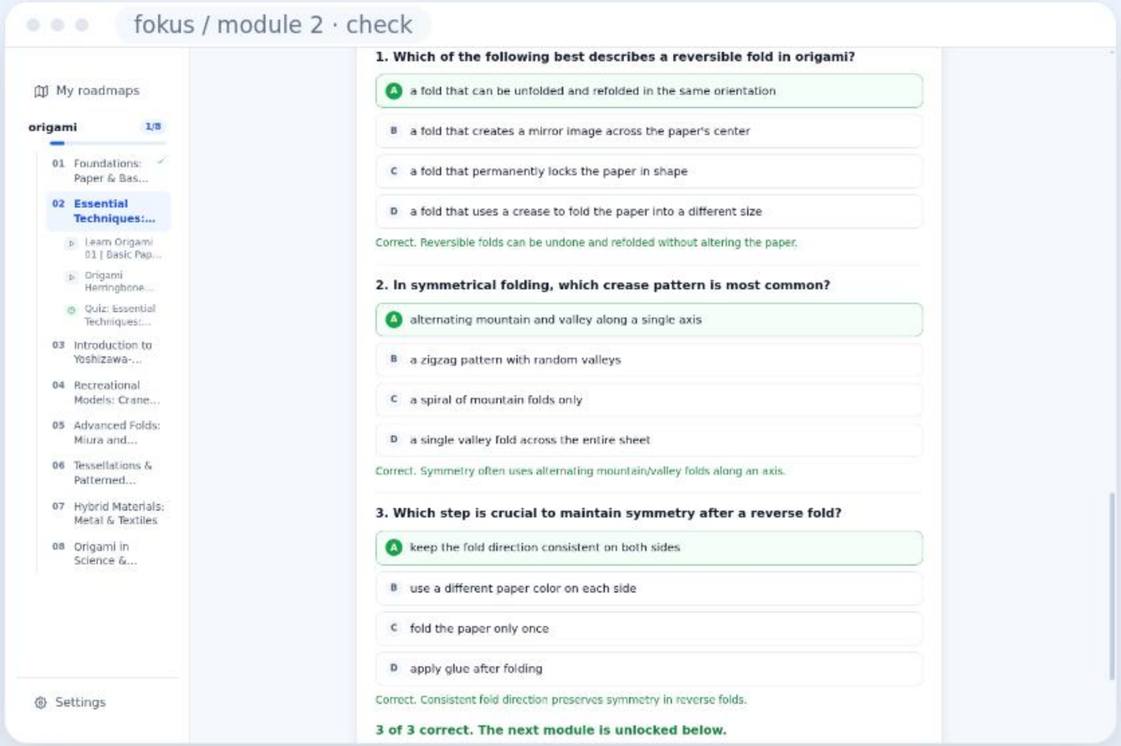
Saved, not lost

Progress is stored per account, and any roadmap can be kept on the device for offline reading.

INSIDE A MODULE

Watch, read, check. Then move on.





1 Watch

Real videos, picked for this module.

2 Read

A tutor-style guide with sources.

3 Check

Three questions, instant feedback.

HOW IT WORKS UNDER THE HOOD

One request, five steps, and nothing invented.

Recommendations are real: videos are scraped from YouTube search and verified, courses are platform search links. No fabricated titles, ids or badges.

LEARNER

Types a topic

Topic gate blocks key-spam and non-learnable input before any model call.

SYSTEM

Researches

Pulls live Wikipedia sources for the topic, and for each module when it opens.

MODEL

Writes 8 modules

Ordered beginner to advanced, each with a one-line scope and a full guide on first open.

SYSTEM

Finds resources

Real YouTube results, verified; course search links per platform.

MODEL

Builds the check

Three questions per module, generated once, stored, scored on the client.

8

modules per roadmap

~2.4s

average generation time per roadmap

1

model call per generated artefact, cached after

0

fabricated links by design

Replace the model step with any provider; the contract is fixed JSON.

WHERE THIS GOES

One engine, three audiences, in order.

Each stage reuses the same topic-in, path-out core. We move only when the stage before it is actually working for its users.

NOW	**Students teaching themselves** One person, one topic, one account. Personal progress and offline copies.	Shipping
NEXT	**Study groups and small cohorts** Shared roadmaps, a class code, and a simple view of who is on which module.	After beta feedback
LATER	**Classrooms and trainers** Instructor-authored paths, assignment deadlines, and per-module completion reporting.	Needs accounts for non-learners
LATER	**Institutions** Faculty-wide deployment, SSO, and content review before a path reaches students.	Needs the stage above to be proven

WHAT IS BUILT TODAY

Not a mockup. A working account-based app.

Learner side

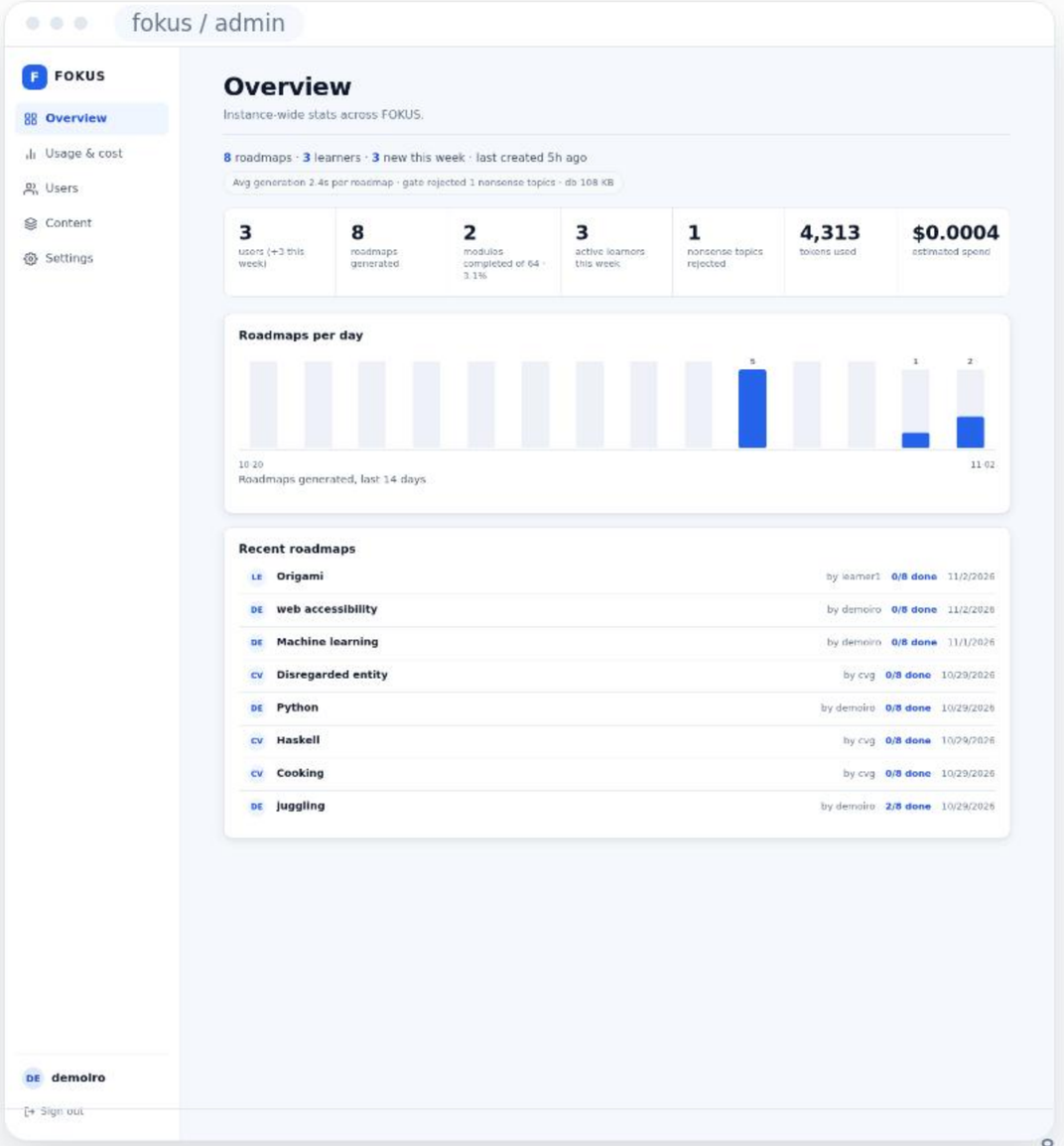
- Accounts, saved roadmaps, progress
- Course sidebar with the module tree
- Watch, read, check per module
- Save any roadmap for offline reading

Operator side

- Usage, cost and token tracking
- Per-user activity and roadmaps
- Content list with progress and export
- Refusals and rate limits visible

Also shipped

Installable as an app on a phone, an Android build, and a public landing page that shows a real roadmap building itself.



WHAT WE KNOW IS MISSING

The honest limit list.

A pitch that hides its constraints gets caught in the first question. These are known, and each has a next step.

Capacity

On a free model tier, a new roadmap costs about 4,000 tokens and a fully opened one about 34,000. That is roughly six fully explored roadmaps per day for the whole instance until we move to a paid key.

Retention evidence

We have no cohort data yet. Fifteen completions across the instance is a signal that the loop works, not proof that people come back.

Surface area

No sharing, no groups, no instructor tools. Roadmaps are personal-only today.

Distribution

Currently hosted on a personal tunnel. A real domain and a managed host are required before any public beta.

WHAT WE WANT NEXT

Ten students, one topic each, one honest list of what broke.

1

Run a closed beta

Ten self-study students make a roadmap on a topic they already know, then open module one and complete its check.

2

Fix the first-run flow

Every broken step found in the beta gets fixed before we invite the next wave. No recruiting everyone at once.

3

Then open the next tier

With the core loop steady, add shared roadmaps for study groups, and only then the classroom features.

Live demo: gateway-hermes.tail62f36e.ts.net/fokus

Android build on the repo releases

The ask is five minutes per tester, not a survey: one topic they already know, module one, and a sentence on where it confused them.